

Interview Questions – Linux Commands

(sreelekha vu -machine test 3)

1. What is the purpose of the touch command?

Answer: The touch command is used to create a new empty file

2. Difference between cp and mv?

Answer:

- cp → Copies files or directories.
- mv → Moves or renames files or directories.

3. How do you rename a file in Linux?

Answer: Use the mv command.

Example:

```
mv old.txt new.txt
```

4. Difference between > and >>?

Answer:

- > → Overwrites the existing content.
- >> → Adds content to the end of the file without deleting existing content.

5. What is the purpose of the cat command?

Answer: cat is used to display, create, or combine the contents of files.

6. Difference between cat and less?

Answer:

- cat → Displays the entire file content at once.
- less → Displays the file page by page.

7. Why is less preferred for large files?

Answer: less allows us to view large files **page by page** without loading and displaying the entire content at once.

8. What does the head command do?

Answer: head displays the **first 10 lines** of a file by default.

9. What does the tail command do?

Answer: tail displays the **last 10 lines** of a file by default.

10. What is the purpose of tail -f?

Answer: tail -f displays new lines added to a file **in real time**. It is commonly used for monitoring log files.

11. What information does wc provide?

Answer: wc provides the **number of lines, words, and characters/bytes** in a file.

12. What does `wc -l` count?

Answer: `wc -l` counts the **number of lines** in a file.

13. What is the purpose of the `file` command?

Answer: The `file` command is used to **identify the type of a file**.

14. Difference between Nano and Vim?

Answer:

- **Nano** → Simple and beginner-friendly text editor.
- **Vim** → More powerful editor with modes and advanced editing features.

15. How do you save and exit Vim?

Answer: Press Esc, type `:wq`, and press **Enter**.

16. How do you exit Vim without saving?

Answer: Press Esc, type `:q!`, and press **Enter**.

17. Why is Vim important for DevOps engineers?

Answer: Vim is useful for editing **configuration files, scripts, and server files**, especially when working on remote Linux servers through a terminal.

18. What is the purpose of `cp -r`?

Answer: `cp -r` copies a **directory and all its contents recursively**.

19. Which command is used to monitor logs in real time?

Answer: `tail -f`

20. Which command is used to identify a file type?

Answer: `file`